How Global Crises Shape YouTube Viewing Habits: An Analysis of Elections, Wars, and Pandemics

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1. Introduction

The contemporary world has turned out to be more digital and now information and entertainment can be easily obtained in online sources like YouTube. In cases of global crisis (election, war, pandemic, etc.), the social behavior and expression of the people change dramatically since individuals want to know news, a reason, or to be distracted (Hartwell and Devinney, 2021). Despite the fact that the effects of YouTube and its ability to influence the opinions of people are well established, there is a deficiency in empirical studies that would investigate the direct effects of the crisis on the viewing behavior. This paper aims at addressing that gap by examining the trending information of YouTube in the framework of the real life events. In such a way, it is intended to describe the way digital media consumption is restructured by global crises and how the audience patterns are affected.

It is critical that researchers and professionals understand how media act in case of crises. As an academic, it offers information on the ways societies modify their information-seeking behavior in a state of uncertainty. On the part of policy makers and the health officials in charge of the whole nation, it will help them know what kind of content people read most during the time of emergency and therefore will devise effective communication strategies. It provides insights into the changing preferences of the audience and the trends of engagement to the media companies and the content creators (Bleier et al., 2024).

This study acknowledges that YouTube has evolved beyond being a source of entertainment to being one of the most important sources of crisis communication, misinformation, and awareness to the populace. The aim of this proposal is to learn the contribution of such global crises that include elections, war, and other pandemics to the viewing habits in YouTube. Thus, the results will contribute to the better comprehension of the digital media dynamics and the work on the enhancement of the online information reliability. It will also give the study a comparative outline through which future crisis related media studies can be given. These insights can be utilized by policymakers and health professionals to enhance information campaigns and creators and media organizations to improve their style of content distribution (Mauro et al., 2024). On the whole, this project is an academically, socially, and practically important project that covers a topical global problem, with extensive research and policy outcomes.

2. Brief Background

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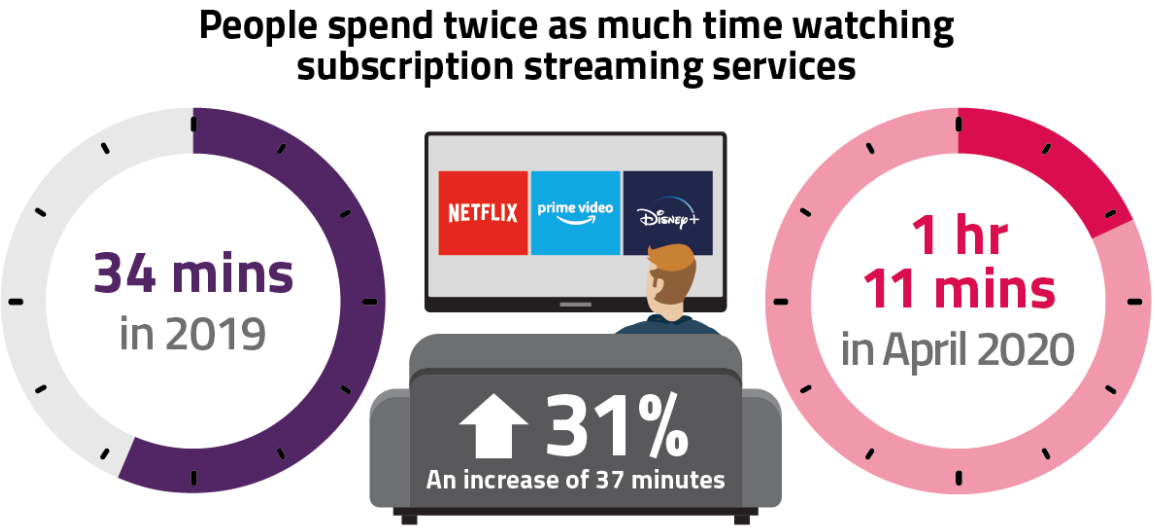

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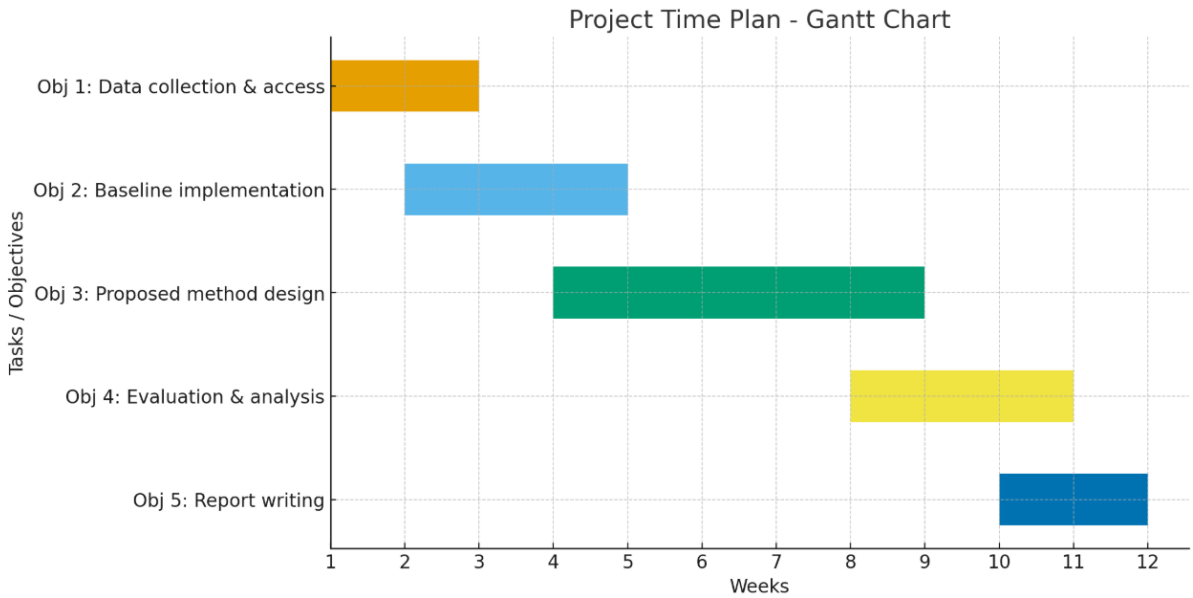

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